



PUBLIC DATA OBSERVATORY

Brand & Style Guide

Visual identity, typography, colour system,
and template guidelines for internal
and external materials.

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1 Brand Foundation

Mission

The Public Data Observatory is an independent data consortium that creates centralized, validated, open datasets linking federal appropriations, workforce, and grant data. We support policymakers, advocates, journalists, and public health leaders with rigorous, timely intelligence on CDC and HHS funding and staffing.

Brand Values

Rigor	Every dataset is validated, version-controlled, and traceable to primary source documents. We do not publish estimates without disclosure.
Transparency	All methodologies are documented. Our data is open and freely downloadable. We disclose limitations plainly.
Accessibility	We translate complex federal data into usable formats for advocates, journalists, and non-technical policymakers.



Independence	PDO is non-partisan. We present data — not advocacy. Our credibility depends on this distinction being legible in every communication.
Urgency	We operate in a fast-moving environment. Timeliness and reliability are equally important. Speed without accuracy is not acceptable.

2 Logo Usage

Primary Logo

The PDO logo consists of a circular icon featuring an observatory dome, telescope, bar chart, and constellation line graph — representing the intersection of scientific observation and data analysis. The wordmark 'PUBLIC DATA OBSERVATORY' is always set in all-caps when paired with the icon.



Primary (on dark)



Medium (min. 60px)



Small (min. 40px)

Logo Clear Space

Maintain clear space equal to the height of the letter 'P' in the wordmark on all sides. Never crowd the logo with other elements.

Logo Restrictions

- × Do not stretch, distort, or rotate the logo.
- × Do not change the logo colours or apply filters.
- × Do not place the logo on backgrounds with insufficient contrast.
- × Do not add drop shadows, outlines, or effects to the logo.
- × Do not use the icon without the wordmark in external communications (unless at small sizes).
- × Minimum display size: 40px / 0.5 inch diameter for the icon alone.

3 Color System



Primary Palette

These three colors form the foundation of all PDO communications. Deep Navy is dominant (60–70% of visual weight). Brand Blue is primary interactive and accent. White provides contrast and breathing room.

Deep Navy #003F61	Brand Blue #0277BD	Logo Blue #3D75C9	White #FFFFFF
Primary bg, headers, dominant	Buttons, links, section accents	Logo, callout backgrounds	Text on dark, slide backgrounds

Secondary Palette

Secondary colors support data differentiation, callouts, and visual accents. Use sparingly — never more than two secondary colors alongside the primary palette in a single layout.

Data Peach #F0B97D	Teal #009688	Forest Green #558B2F	Steel Grey #CFD8DC
Data elements, pull quotes, dividers	Supporting charts, third data series	Positive trend indicators	Borders, dividers, secondary text

Functional / UI Palette

Light Background #F4F7FB	Body Text #1A2F3F	Muted Text #546E7A	Sky Blue #9FC5E8
Slide/doc bg, card fills	Primary text on light	Captions, footnotes, secondary	Text on navy, light links

Colour Accessibility

Combination	Contrast	WCAG AA	Use Case
White on Deep Navy (#003F61)	10.5:1	✓ Pass	Body text, headlines
White on Brand Blue (#0277BD)	5.1:1	✓ Pass	Button text, labels
White on Logo Blue (#3D75C9)	4.0:1	✓ AA (large)	Headers ≥ 18pt
Deep Navy on Light Bg (#F4F7FB)	9.8:1	✓ Pass	Body text on light
Sky Blue (#9FC5E8) on Deep Navy	3.2:1	■ Large only	Captions ≥ 14pt only

4 Typography

Typeface System

PDO uses a two-typeface system: **Roboto Slab** for display and headline use (authoritative, structured, data-friendly) and **Arial** for body copy and UI text (universal, clean, accessible). Never substitute other typefaces without approval.

Role	Typeface	Weight	Size	Colour	Usage
Display / Cover Title	Roboto Slab	Bold	36–52pt	White on Navy	Presentation cover slides
Slide Title	Roboto Slab	Bold	22–28pt	White or Navy	All slide titles
Section Heading (H2)	Arial	Bold	18–22pt	Deep Navy	Document section headers
Sub-heading (H3)	Arial	Bold	14–16pt	Brand Blue	Sub-sections, callout labels
Body Text	Arial	Regular	10–12pt	Body Text #1A2F3F	All narrative text
Data Label / Caption	Arial	Regular	8–9pt	Muted #546E7A	Chart labels, footnotes
Stat Callout Number	Roboto Slab	Bold	32–64pt	White or Navy	Big-number callout cards
Wordmark / All-Caps Label	Arial	Bold	8–11pt	Navy or White	Org name, section labels

Typography Rules

- Never use more than two typefaces in a single layout.
- Maintain a minimum contrast ratio of 4.5:1 for body text; 3:1 for large text (≥ 18 pt).
- Left-align all body text and lists. Centre only titles and stat callouts.
- Use sentence case for body; title case for headings; all-caps only for labels with tracking applied.
- Line length: 55–80 characters for body text. Avoid lines shorter than 40 characters.
- Use Roboto Slab sparingly in documents — it is a display font, not a body font.

5 Layout & Spacing

Grid System

All PDO layouts use an 8pt baseline grid. Spacing values should be multiples of 8 (8, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64). This creates consistent vertical rhythm across all material types.

Context	Margins	Content Width	Column Structure
PowerPoint (16:9)	0.5"	9"	Full-bleed or 2-col (4.5"/4.5")



Word Report (Letter)	1" all sides	6.5"	Single column; 2-col tables for data
Fact Sheet (Letter)	0.75"	7"	2-col: 2" stat / 5" narrative
External Email	20px	600px max	Single column; centred at 600px
Social / Web Graphic	5% edge margin	Flexible	Square (1:1) or 16:9 landscape

6 Data Visualization

Chart Colour Sequence

Apply brand colours to data series in this order. Never use colours not in this palette. Ensure all data series have sufficient contrast for accessibility (3:1 minimum).

Series 1 #0277BD	Series 2 #F0B97D	Series 3 #009688	Series 4 #558B2F
Brand Blue (primary)	Data Peach (secondary)	Teal (tertiary)	Forest Green
Series 5 #3D75C9	Series 6 #003F61	Series 7 #9FC5E8	Series 8 #CFD8DC
Logo Blue	Deep Navy	Sky Blue (light)	Steel Grey (neutral)

Visualization Standards

- Always include a source citation below every chart. Format: "Source: [Agency] · [Document] · [Fiscal Year]"
- Do not use 3D charts. Use flat, clean 2D visualizations only.
- Include axis labels on all charts. Suppress unnecessary gridlines — use value-axis gridlines only.
- Color alone must not be the only differentiator (use patterns or labels for accessibility).
- Large stat callouts ("">\$11.4B", "51%"): use Roboto Slab Bold, 32–64pt, on Deep Navy or Brand Blue background.
- Maps: use the Blues sequential palette (light = lower values, Deep Navy = highest) for choropleth.
- All charts must be legible at 100% zoom and when printed in greyscale.

7 Template Overview

Available Templates



PowerPoint Master Template

[PDO_Presentation_Template.pptx](#)

7-slide master template with Cover, Section Divider, Content + Stat Cards, Data/Chart, Two-Column, Pull Quote, and Closing slides. Includes stat callout cards, chart placeholder, and header/footer system.

Recommended for:
Policymaker briefings, funder presentations, media backgrounders, internal team updates

Word Report Template

[PDO_Report_Template.docx](#)

Full-length report template with branded cover block, executive summary, key findings callout, data table, methodology section, recommendations, and About PDO block. Includes header/footer with auto page numbering.

Recommended for:
Data releases, methodology documentation, policy briefs, white papers

Fact Sheet / One-Pager Template

[PDO_FactSheet_Template.docx](#)

Single-page template with navy header, two-column layout (stat callout cards left, narrative right), and CTA footer. Designed for rapid distribution to press and policymakers.

Recommended for:
Press releases, event leave-behinds, advocacy one-pagers, rapid-response briefs

8 Tone & Voice

Editorial Standards

PDO communications are authoritative, precise, and evidence-based. We are a trusted source of record — not an advocacy organization Every claim is grounded in primary-source data.

Write this ✓	Not this ✕
CDC FY2025 appropriations totaled \$9.3 billion, a 14% decrease from FY2024.	CDC's budget has been slashed dramatically in recent years.
51% of total annual CDC funding is at risk of cancellation based on current OMB proposals.	Over half of all CDC funding could be cut — this is alarming.
The HHS Employee Directory showed 113,636 staff on March 25, 2026, down 0.4% from February.	Thousands of HHS employees have been fired recently.
Our methodology follows CDC's appropriations framework. Figures reflect enacted levels unless noted.	We think these are the right numbers.

Audience-Specific Guidance



Policymakers & Staff: Lead with bottom-line numbers. Use dollar amounts and percentages. Avoid jargon. Include 'what this means for [state/program]'.

Journalists & Media: Provide context and comparisons. Always include source citations and methodology notes. Anticipate 'how do you know?' questions.

Funders & Donors: Connect data to mission impact. Explain why independent data infrastructure matters. Be specific about what PDO uniquely provides.

Internal / Technical: Full detail is appropriate. Include field-level documentation, version notes, known limitations, and FOIA status.

9 File Formats & Assets

Logo Files

File	Format	Use Case
pdo_logo.svg	SVG (vector)	Web, large-format print, any scalable application
pdo_logo.png	PNG (transparent)	Documents, presentations, digital materials
pdo_logo_dark_bg.png	PNG (for dark)	Use on navy/dark backgrounds
pdo_logo_light_bg.png	PNG (for light)	Use on white/light backgrounds

Colour Quick Reference

Colour Name	Hex	RGB	Primary Use
Deep Navy	#003F61	0, 63, 97	Backgrounds, headers, dominant color
Brand Blue	#0277BD	2, 119, 189	Buttons, accent bars, links
Logo Blue	#3D75C9	61, 117, 201	Logo, callout backgrounds
Data Peach	#F0B97D	240, 185, 125	Data viz accent, dividers
Teal	#009688	0, 150, 136	Chart series 3, supporting accent
Forest Green	#558B2F	85, 139, 47	Positive indicators, chart series 4
Steel Grey	#CFD8DC	207, 216, 220	Borders, dividers, muted elements
Light Background	#F4F7FB	244, 247, 251	Slide/doc backgrounds, card fills
Body Text	#1A2F3F	26, 47, 63	Primary text on light backgrounds
Muted Text	#546E7A	84, 110, 122	Captions, footnotes, secondary text
Sky Blue	#9FC5E8	159, 197, 232	Text on navy, light-on-dark links



Questions & Contacts

For questions about brand usage, logo requests, or template customization, contact the PDO communications team at info@publicdataobservatory.org.

For data inquiries, methodology questions, or press requests, visit <https://publicdataobservatory.org>.